

but most with two or more. On a few desks 15 of these television sets were stacked three or four high, some showing bar graphs, others showing charts with wiggly lines, and others long columns of numbers. The computers were cooled with desktop electric fans that seemed quite primitive compared to the electronics.

There must have been 1,000 telephones, enough to service a small town. On some desks, entire switchboards were set up between the stacks of computers. Being escorted around them by a public relations officer made it impossible to learn much, but I did discover that Salomon's traders were buying and selling stocks and bonds around the world, 24 hours a day. Their telephones were hooked up to the floors of various stock exchanges, or else to the offices of brokers and other dealers. If a U.S. market was closed, then London or Rome might be open, and after that there was always Singapore or Japan or Hong Kong. Many employees were busily trading bonds, but those who dealt in stocks took their orders from portfolio managers who sat together around the corner.

It seemed futile to talk to a portfolio manager with all the commotion surrounding us here, so I thanked my escort for the tour and left the building. From the lobby below, I called to make the appointment to visit Mr. Platt.

Bankers Trust is located in a midtown building, just off Fifth Avenue and not far from Grand Central Station. I met Mr. Platt in a conference room, and gave him Ms. Molter's regards. If you put him in a crowd of people and asked me to pick him out today I'd fail, so there's no point in my pretending to recall his appearance. I'm sure he was dressed in a sensible suit. I remember he said he was 40 years old, lived in Westchester, had a nice family, had his M.B.A., did his undergraduate work at Cornell, came to Bankers Trust from Marine Midland, and had worked here seven years. He also mentioned he was an unusual portfolio manager, since he doubled as a buy-side analyst. He got input from the sell side and from the buy side, and then invested the \$150 million in pension fund money under his control.

Mr. Platt gave me a tour of the Bankers Trust trading room, a miniature version of the Salomon Brothers setup, with four or five people manning the desks. He said the traders were very valuable as mini-specialists, since they knew where big blocks of stock were